



THE AGENTIC WEB

WHAT MARKETERS MUST DO TO PREPARE



Introduction

Search is no longer just about helping users find information. It is increasingly about helping them *complete outcomes*.

As AI systems become more capable, they are moving beyond answering questions to acting on behalf of users. These systems can compare options, evaluate products, schedule services, and complete transactions across digital environments.

This emerging ecosystem is often referred to as the Agentic Web.

For organizations, this shift changes the rules of digital discovery. Instead of simply optimizing content for search engines or conversational AI, brands must now prepare their data and systems so that AI agents can interpret, evaluate, and interact with them directly.

This evolution introduces new challenges for marketing, SEO, and digital strategy teams. Traditional metrics such as rankings, clicks, and sessions may no longer fully capture how influence occurs when AI mediates the user journey.

At the same time, the underlying infrastructure that supports discovery is becoming more important than ever. Structured data, knowledge graphs, and interoperable standards are quickly becoming the foundation that enables AI systems to understand entities, relationships, and available actions.

This ebook explores what this shift means for enterprise organizations and digital leaders.

In this eBook, you will learn:

- What the Agentic Web is and how it differs from earlier phases of AI-driven search
- The technology layers that enable AI agents to reason, retrieve information, and take action
- How discovery, evaluation, and customer journeys are changing in an AI-mediated environment
- How to prepare your brand to be agent-ready

The Collapse of the Traditional Search Funnel



For two decades, search followed a predictable pattern:

Keyword → SERP → Website → Conversion

Users entered queries, scanned ranked results, visited websites, and made decisions. AI has already begun compressing this journey by synthesizing answers directly within the search interface.

THE AGENTIC WEB TAKES IT ONE STEP FURTHER

Instead of simply presenting information, AI systems increasingly evaluate options and execute tasks on behalf of users.

In this model, the website is no longer always the primary interaction surface. Instead of short-tail queries, users are directly asking for *outcomes*. Agents retrieve structured data, compare options, and complete actions such as booking appointments, submitting forms, or making purchases.

This is not just a new search interface. It represents a fundamental shift in how information is discovered, interpreted, and acted upon.

And, as with every major shift on the web, **the infrastructure change comes first.**

THE DATA LAYER THAT ENABLES THE AGENTIC WEB IS NOW BEING BUILT USING STRUCTURED DATA, KNOWLEDGE GRAPHS, AND INTEROPERABLE PROTOCOLS TO ALLOW AI SYSTEMS TO UNDERSTAND ENTITIES ON A WEBSITE AND TRIGGER ACTIONS FOR THE USER.

Organizations that structure their content, define their entities, and govern their data today will be the ones AI agents can discover, evaluate, and act on tomorrow.

What is the Agentic Web

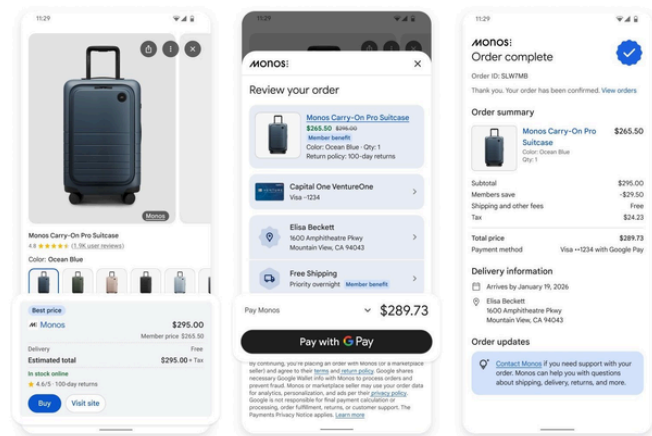
...and how is it changing SEO and discovery today?

THE AGENTIC WEB IS AN ECOSYSTEM WHERE AUTONOMOUS AI AGENTS RETRIEVE STRUCTURED DATA, REASON OVER IT, AND EXECUTE TASKS ACROSS SYSTEMS.

Unlike traditional search engines or chat interfaces that return answers, these agents perform actions. They can compare vendors, shortlist products, submit forms, book appointments, complete purchases, automate workflows... the list goes on.

A consumer can ask an agent,
“Find a hardshell medium-sized suitcase with a lock and expandable zipper under the price of \$250.”

The agent acts as a personal shopper, shortlisting products and enabling the consumer to purchase them directly through the search interface.



This seamless experience completely bypasses the website, driving conversions directly through the agent.

This shift, a.k.a the Agentic Commerce, is already visible across major technology platforms like ChatGPT, Copilot, Perplexity, Google AI mode, and more.

As a result, the role of digital infrastructure is changing.

- The browser is evolving from a viewing environment into an automation layer.
- The website is evolving from a destination into a data source and execution endpoint.

With this change, machine readability is foundational for brands seeking to be selected by an agent.

If your content is not structured or accessible to agents, they cannot use it reliably. Without it, the agent risks misunderstanding the offering – which can lead to consumer misinformation – or bypassing the brand entirely.

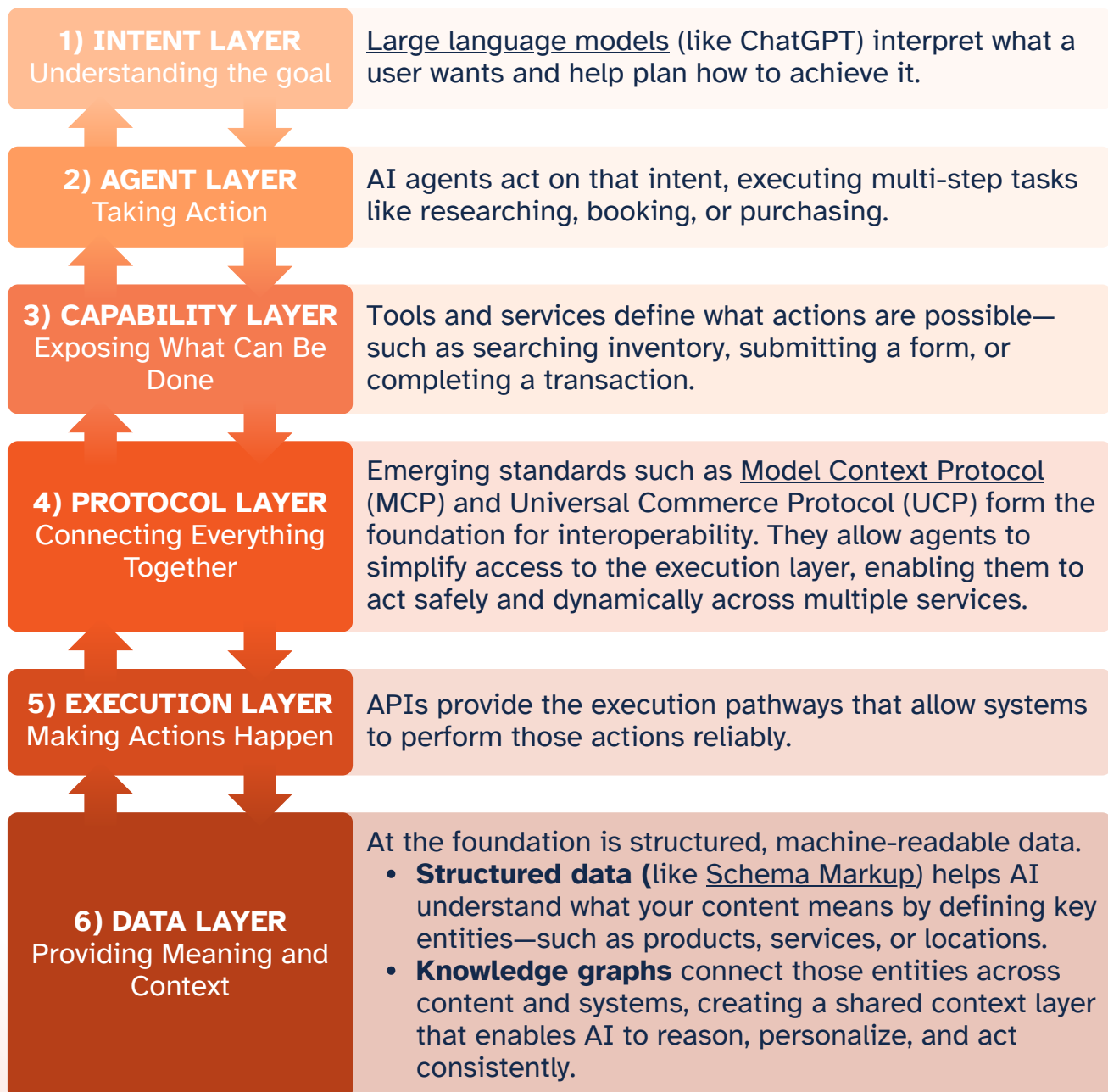
The Infrastructure Layer

Enabling the Agentic Web

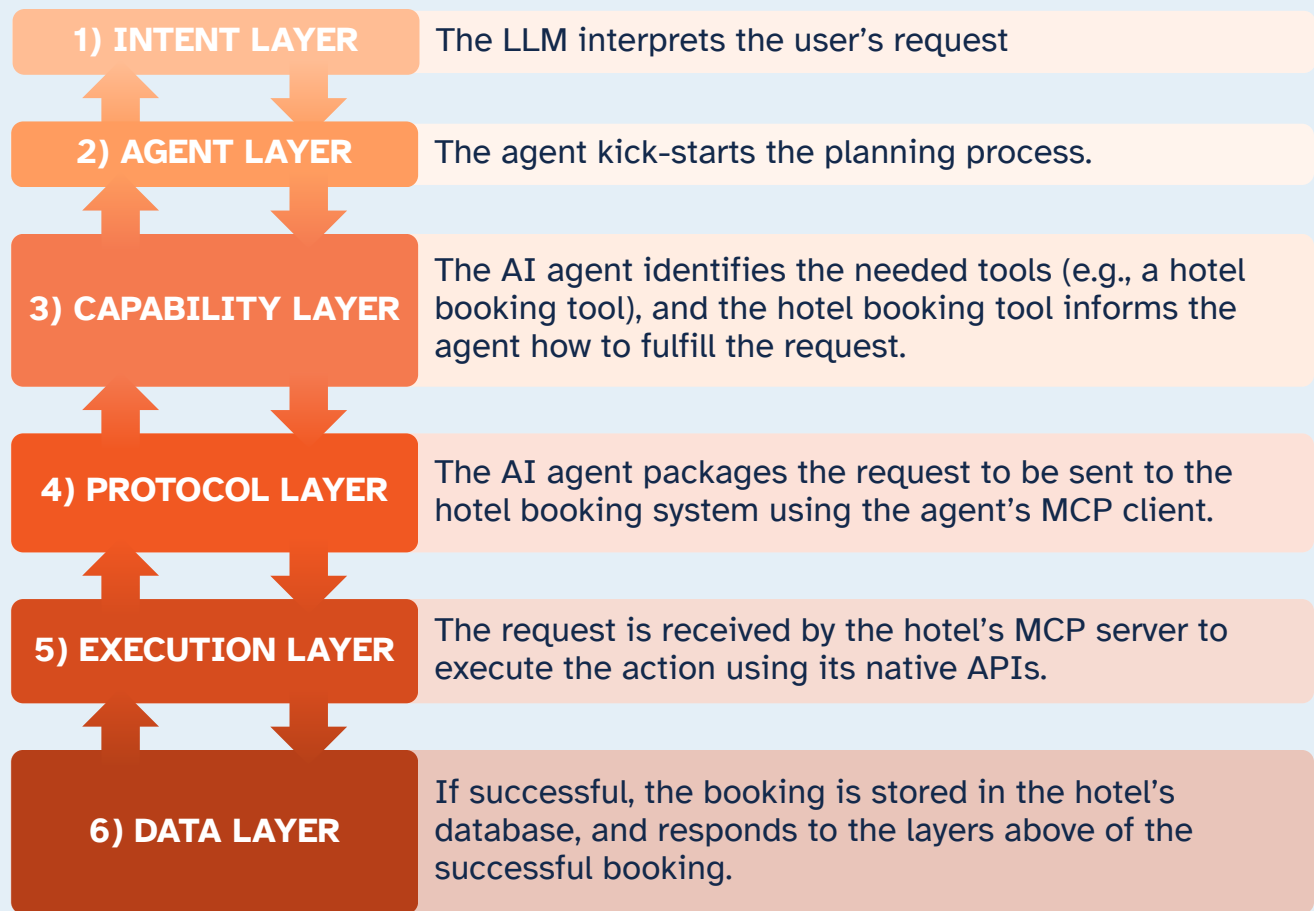
WHAT POWERS THE AGENTIC WEB?

The Agentic Web depends on connected, machine-readable data—and a set of technologies that turn user intent into action.

At a high level, six layers work together to make this possible:



For example, when a user searches *“Help me book the Four Seasons hotel in Vancouver from May 3 – 8, 2026”*

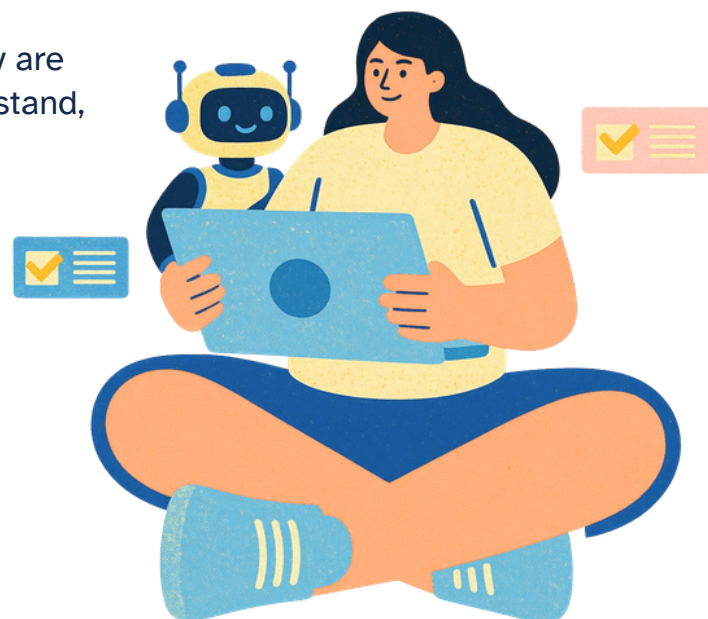


A SHIFT IN HOW THE WEB WORKS

Together, these layers represent a fundamental shift—from users navigating systems step-by-step to AI systems executing goals on their behalf.

Websites are no longer built only for humans. They are becoming environments that AI agents can understand, query, and act within.

Plain text content and APIs alone are no longer enough. To participate in the Agentic Web, your data must be structured, connected, and accessible through agent-friendly interfaces.



BUT WHY DO KNOWLEDGE GRAPHS MATTER?

This is where most companies get it wrong. AI doesn't just need data—it needs *context*.

Knowledge graphs do more than store information. They define relationships between entities and establish a shared semantic layer, so that concepts like products, customers, or locations are understood consistently across systems and AI agents.

This shared understanding becomes critical as multiple AI agents interact with your systems, ensuring they interpret and act on your data in the same way.

Without this grounding, generative systems rely on statistical prediction alone. That increases the risk of hallucinations, ambiguity, and inconsistent brand representation.

When AI systems are grounded in a well-defined knowledge graph, the outcome changes. Accuracy improves. Context is preserved and meaning becomes consistent.

For enterprises, this is not optional. Adopting AI without a governed, structured data foundation leads to unreliable outputs and loss of control over how your brand is represented.

The companies that win in the Agentic Web will be the ones that invest in trusted, connected data—because that is what makes intelligent, autonomous systems actually work.

**LEARN MORE ABOUT HOW KNOWLEDGE
GRAPHS POWER AI SEARCH [HERE](#).**

Entity-Level SEO

The Foundation of the Agentic Web

This shift in infrastructure also changes how organizations approach SEO.

Traditional SEO focused on optimizing pages to rank in search results. In the Agentic Web, success depends on whether AI systems can *understand, evaluate, and act on* your organization's data.

This requires moving beyond page-level optimization toward entity-level clarity. Schema Markup becomes the interface between your brand and AI systems, while your Content Knowledge Graph provides the contextual layer that defines meaning.

One of the key mechanisms that enables this is Entity Linking.

Entity linking is the process of identifying entities—distinct things or concepts—in your content and linking them to clearly defined entities on your website or in external knowledge bases such as Wikidata or Google's Knowledge Graph.

It removes ambiguity and helps search engines and AI understand your content correctly—improving visibility and reducing risk of hallucinations.

When entities are clearly defined and consistently linked across your content, they begin to form a connected network of meaning. This network is what becomes your Content Knowledge Graph.



BUILDING A CONTENT KNOWLEDGE GRAPH REQUIRES:

- Clear page categorization using Schema.org types.
- Depth through descriptive Schema.org properties that define entities in detail.
- Schema Markup coverage across all key pages and content areas.
- Unique resource identifiers (e.g. @id) to distinguish the entities and make them referenceable across your site and beyond.
- Strong internal and external entity linking for disambiguation and context.

 **Download our ebook to learn how to build your content knowledge graph**

Together, these elements create a structured layer of meaning that AI systems can interpret, reason over, and use to evaluate your organization.

How the Agentic Web Impacts the User Journey

AI agents are increasingly becoming the first touchpoint between users and brands. As they take on more responsibility in discovery, evaluation, and execution, the traditional lead lifecycle evolves.

CUTTING OUT THE MIDDLE MAN IN THE EARLY FUNNEL

Awareness shifts from website visits to AI-mediated discovery.

Instead of researching across multiple websites, users ask agents for outcomes. Agents retrieve structured data, summarize options, and narrow choices before the user engages directly with any brand.

Your brand may influence decisions without generating a website session. If agents cannot clearly interpret your structured data, your organization may never enter consideration.



MARKETING INSIGHT

As discovery shifts toward AI-generated answers and agent-completed tasks, marketing influence is no longer measured solely by website traffic or clicks. Brands may shape decisions without generating a session, which means traditional KPIs like rankings, CTR, and page visits capture only part of the picture.

Marketing teams will increasingly need to measure presence, influence, and selection within AI-driven experiences, not just website engagement.

MID-FUNNEL COMPRESSION

Evaluation becomes faster and more automated.

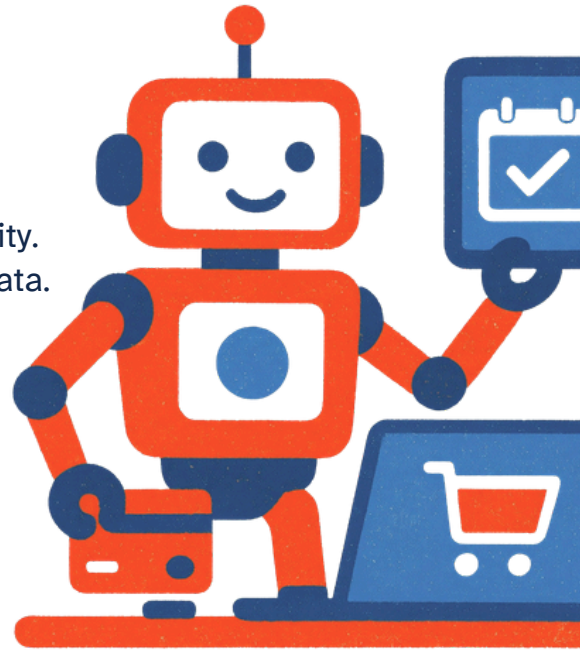
Agents compare vendors based on attributes such as features, pricing, availability, certifications, and compatibility. All of these attributes can be included in your structured data. Your structured data effectively becomes a proxy sales representative.

Agent-driven actions may include:

- Purchasing a product
- Submitting contact forms
- Booking demos
- Scheduling appointments
- Initiating applications

This compresses the consideration phase. Instead of users manually validating options, agents pre-qualify them.

Supporting this shift requires organizations to define clear entity attributes, action endpoints, and validation rules. Marketing, IT, and product teams must work together to ensure that the structured data enables the agents to execute the tasks properly.



POST-CONVERSION AUTOMATION

The impact of the Agentic Web does not stop at acquisition.

Agents can also manage ongoing customer relations tasks, including subscriptions, renewals, support requests, account updates, and more.

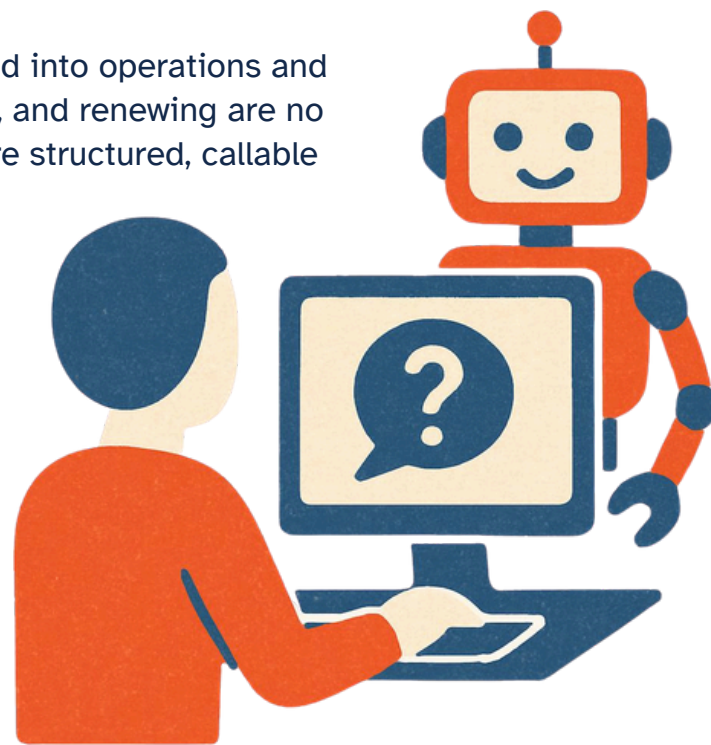
Customer engagement shifts from repeated website visits to automated workflows executed on the user's behalf.

Agent-driven actions extend beyond marketing and into operations and service layers. Booking, updating, troubleshooting, and renewing are no longer just front-end website experiences. They are structured, callable processes that agents can trigger.

To support this shift, organizations must define:

- Clear action endpoints
- Required inputs and validation rules
- Success and failure conditions
- Governance and compliance guardrails

MORE ON THIS LATER IN THE EBOOK!



HOW WILL THE AGENTIC WEB IMPACT SEOS AND MARKETERS?

For SEO and marketing teams, this shift introduces new responsibilities.

Instead of focusing primarily on pages and keywords, teams must now define the entities their organization wants to be known for and ensure those entities are consistently represented across their digital presence.

This changes how teams approach...

Content strategy —→ Organizing content around entities and topics rather than isolated keywords

SEO measurement —→ Evaluating performance at the entity and topic level instead of only keywords and page traffic

Brand representation → Ensuring AI systems interpret and represent products, services, and expertise accurately

Cross-functional collaboration —→ Working with product, IT, and data teams to maintain a content knowledge graph to ensure machines can understand meaning and context across systems

In the Agentic Web, marketers are no longer optimizing only for how humans discover content. They are also responsible for ensuring AI systems can ***understand***, ***compare***, and ***act on*** their organization's data.

Teams that build strong entity foundations today will be far better positioned to participate in AI-driven discovery tomorrow.

THE ATTRIBUTION PROBLEM

As AI agents mediate more interactions, traditional measurement models like clicks and sessions begin to break down.

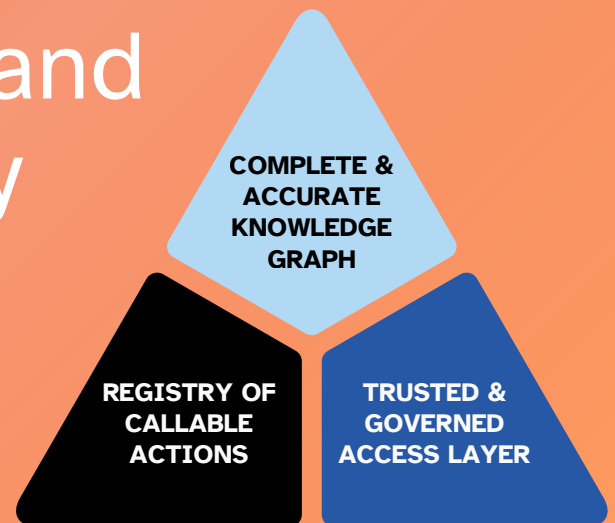
- If the AI agent influences the decision, who receives credit?
- How do you measure influence when the interaction does not occur on your website?
- What does traffic mean when discovery happens inside AI interfaces?

There isn't a hard, quantifiable answer to these questions. In this environment, search performance must be evaluated at the entity and topic level to ensure you are showing up for things you want your brand to be known for.

Learn more about managing and evaluating performance on the entity and topic level [here](#).

Preparing Your Brand to Be Agent-Ready

The shift toward AI-driven discovery requires organizations to rethink how their digital infrastructure is structured. Becoming agent-ready begins with three foundational components.



1. A COMPLETE AND ACCURATE KNOWLEDGE GRAPH

As mentioned earlier, agents cannot act on what they do not understand. Before an agent can book, compare, or recommend, it must first understand what the thing is, how it relates, and where it fits in context.

Your knowledge graph is that structured data layer that defines the entities on your site and the connections between them. A data layer that the agent can reliably act on. So what does a complete and accurate knowledge graph entail?

ACCESSIBLE AND COMPREHENSIVE ENTITY DEFINITIONS

- Each entity should have a single, clearly defined source of truth (i.e. an entity home) that fully describes it and all its relevant properties. That definition must be structured so both humans and AI systems can consistently access it.

CLEAR RELATIONSHIPS BETWEEN ENTITIES THAT ENABLE INFERENCE

- Your entities must be connected in a way that reflects how your business actually operates, linking products, services, locations, and more. These relationships give AI the context it needs to infer meaning and relevance. Agents can navigate these connections to answer complex, multi-step queries and take action.

CONSISTENT REPRESENTATION OF ENTITIES

- Each entity must be represented consistently across all touchpoints, including your website, structured data, APIs, and external channels. Assigning a unique identifier (@id) ensures the entity can be reliably recognized and referenced across systems.

Without this structured data layer, AI systems cannot reliably interpret or compare your organization.

2. A REGISTRY OF CALLABLE ACTIONS

Agents not only retrieve information. They execute tasks. Organizations need a machine-readable registry of their business actions so agents know how to engage.

HOW TO BUILD A REGISTRY OF CALLABLE ACTIONS

1

IDENTIFY THE KEY ACTIONS

- Identify the key actions customers take with your business, such as booking, purchasing, applying, requesting, or scheduling.
- Define the actions using a machine-readable model (e.g., using [Schema.org](#) Action Types, such as [ScheduleAction](#) or [BuyAction](#) or equivalent schemas), so AI systems can recognize and trigger them seamlessly.

2

CLARIFY THE CUSTOMER INPUTS

- Expose required inputs in a machine-readable format (e.g., via schema properties, API specifications, or MCP-compatible tool schemas) so agents know what fields to collect, validate, and submit for each action.

3

PARTNER WITH IT / SERVICE TEAMS FOR TECHNICAL SPECS

- Define the rules and conditions that govern each action (e.g., eligibility, pricing, timing) so agents understand who, when, and how the action can be performed.
- Specify authentication requirements (e.g., login, account, token) so agents can securely verify identity before executing the action.
- Define success and failure outcomes so agents know how to respond, retry, or guide the user when issues occur.
- Expose clear entry points (e.g., APIs, URLs, workflows) so agents know where and how to trigger the action.

4

MAINTAIN A CENTRAL REGISTRY

- Maintain a centralized, up-to-date registry of all actions and how they can be triggered, so agents can reliably discover and execute them.

3. A TRUSTED AND GOVERNED ACCESS LAYER

AI agents will only act on data they can trust. If your data is inconsistent, untraceable, or non-compliant, agents may misinterpret it, ignore it, or expose your organization to risk.

Your structured data, in the form of a knowledge graph, must therefore be accessible, accurate, and governed. To enable this, organizations must:

DEFINE GOVERNANCE POLICIES FOR ENTITY ACCURACY

- Establish clear governance policies to maintain entity accuracy and ensure consistent brand representation across all AI touchpoints.

ENSURE AUDITABILITY AND TRACEABILITY OF DATA

- Maintain auditability and traceability of data changes so you can explain the source, timing, and version of any agent-generated fact. This enables you to validate, defend, and ensure compliance of AI-driven outputs.

MEET ENTERPRISE SECURITY AND COMPLIANCE STANDARDS

- Ensure your data layer meets industry and regulatory requirements (e.g., HIPAA, GDPR, SOC2) so information is handled and exposed securely.

ADOPT OPEN, INTEROPERABLE STANDARDS

- Build your knowledge graph using open standards (e.g., RDF, Schema.org, PROV-O, MCP, NLWeb) to ensure it is machine-readable, portable, and accessible across systems.

ENSURE CROSS-SYSTEM ACCESSIBILITY AND REUSE

- Make your knowledge graph accessible and reusable across search, AI systems, agents, and internal tools.

In the Agentic Web, a website that only presents information becomes a passive brochure. A website that exposes structured meaning and callable actions becomes an active participant in AI-driven discovery.

The Organizations That Will Win in the Agentic Web

Every major shift in the web has rewarded organizations that adapted their infrastructure early.

The Agentic Web introduces a new competitive layer. In this environment, influence is determined not only by what humans see, but by what AI systems can interpret, evaluate, and act upon.

Organizations that succeed will treat structured data as a strategic asset. They will ensure their products, services, expertise, and capabilities are clearly defined, consistently represented, and accessible to the systems that increasingly shape digital decisions.

This is not simply an SEO initiative. It is a shift in how organizations manage knowledge, represent their brand, and expose their capabilities across digital ecosystems.

For digital leaders, the opportunity is clear:

- Align marketing, product, and data teams around a shared understanding of entities and topics
- Treat structured data and knowledge graphs as core digital infrastructure
- Ensure your organization's offerings can be interpreted and compared by AI systems
- Continuously monitor how your brand is represented across emerging AI experiences

The organizations that act now will not only remain visible in the next generation of search. They will help define how AI systems understand their industry.

The Agentic Web is still taking shape. But the direction is clear. The question is no longer whether AI agents will influence discovery and decision-making.

It is whether your organization will be structured and prepared enough to participate.

Kickstart your Agentic Web Journey with Schema App

Participating in the Agentic Web requires a system that makes your data clear, connected, and actionable for AI. We can help.

Using advanced Schema Markup, Schema App builds and manages your Content Knowledge Graph, enabling AI systems to understand your organization and act on its data.

With Schema App, you can:

- **Identify and define your key entities at scale** using our [Highlighter tool](#) and [Entity Linking](#) feature, ensuring AI systems interpret your content accurately
- **Connect those entities to a well-defined Content Knowledge Graph**, creating a clear, contextual, referenceable data layer across your website
- **Manage and maintain your entities data at scale** with [Entity Manager](#), so your brand is represented accurately and authoritatively in AI-driven experiences
- **Identify gaps and opportunities** with [Entity Reports](#) to strengthen your coverage of the topics that mean most to your organization
- **Measure performance at the entity level** with [Entity Performance Analytics](#) to optimize how you show up in search and AI

REQUEST A DEMO WITH OUR TEAM

Book a demo to assess your readiness and take control of how your organization participates in the Agentic Web today!

BOOK A DEMO